

MARUWA (5344.T): Results briefing: Prospects for upside to new guidance for AI/semiconductor applications; Buy

MARUWA held its 1Q3/27 results briefing at 10am JST on July 31 at which it explained 1Q results by application and the outlook from 2Q onward. Key points were: (1) Full-year sales guidance for AI applications was raised significantly to +110%, from +50% previously. The company expects the Seto No. 2 plant to start mass production and contribute to sales from 3Q. Given strong near-term demand, management intends to take steps to bring forward production at the No. 3 plant. (2) The company confirmed the launch of products for CPO applications from 4Q, and this was a factor behind the upward revision to AI applications. (3) Full-year sales growth (yoy) for semiconductor applications was revised up to +20%, from +14%, but the company's tone suggested upside is possible given the current strength of inquiries. In light of this strong demand, MARUWA plans to bring forward the start-up of two new buildings at the Miharu plant to 2Q, from the previously scheduled 2H.

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We view the briefing as positive, reinforcing our view that there is potential upside to guidance for AI/semiconductor applications. We reiterate our Buy rating, based on a structural growth story centered on AI applications. For details on 1Q results by segment, new full-year guidance, our impressions, and key points from investor feedback, please refer to our reports published on the day of the earnings announcement ([LINK](#), [LINK](#)).

Key points from the results briefing are as follows (company commentary unless otherwise noted)

(1) Telecommunications: 1Q sales were ¥9.2 bn. **Full-year sales guidance for AI applications was raised substantially to +110%, from +50% previously.** The upward revision was driven by improved visibility as strong forecasts at the start of the fiscal year translated into confirmed orders. Management's tone suggested that near-term inquiries are strong and it expects further sales growth. The company assumes **mass production and a sales contribution from the Seto No. 2 plant from 3Q**, and while the quarterly schedule for the No. 3 plant, which is scheduled for completion and start-up in FY3/28, is undecided, it intends **to take steps to bring forward production given the strong demand.** Guidance for full-year sales growth (yoy) for the segment was revised up to +48%, from +23%.

(2) CPO-related products: A launch from 4Q was confirmed, and was a factor behind the upward revision to AI applications. Orders are already large, with mass production scheduled for FY3/28.

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(3) Automotive: 1Q sales were ¥3.5 bn. Sales for xEV applications remained solid. Inquiries from major existing customers are increasing, and MARUWA expects sales growth in differentiated products. Guidance for full-year sales growth (yoy) for the segment was revised up to +6%, from +2%.

(4) Semiconductors: 1Q sales were ¥2.2 bn. The company expects sales of c.¥3 bn in 2Q, and over ¥3 bn in 2H (3Q/4Q). Guidance for full-year sales growth (yoy) for the segment was revised up to +20%, from +14%, but management's tone suggested upside is possible given the current strength of inquiries. In light of this strong demand, MARUWA plans **to bring forward the start-up of two new buildings at the Miharu plant to 2Q, from the previously scheduled 2H**, increasing production capacity by (at least) +50% from the previous level. This will lead to a production system capable of meeting future increases in demand.

(5) 1Q operating profits: 1Q results were in line with company expectations. The main reason for the qoq decline in the operating margin was the 1Q shipment of work-in-progress inventory produced in 4Q, when yield issues occurred for new products. Shipments of this low-margin inventory were fully completed within 1Q, and thus management expects margins to improve from 2Q.

Earnings revisions, target price

We leave our FY3/27-FY3/29 operating profit estimates unchanged, but revise our quarterly breakdown and make minor tweaks to our EPS and net profit estimates (less than 1%). We leave our 12-month target price unchanged at ¥89,000, and we maintain our Buy rating.

MARUWA

Investment Thesis - MARUWA

As a ceramics supplier, MARUWA's history dates back nearly 200 years. The company provides a wide range of ceramic products mainly for applications in fields such as (1) telecommunications, (2) autos, (3) semiconductors, and (4) industrial equipment. MARUWA has been transforming its business portfolio since the mid-2000s, shifting its focus from highly commoditized and cyclical products that face intense price-based competition to high-margin products for niche markets that require customization. Margins have improved sharply as a result, and MARUWA has won high share in niche markets with strong growth potential. It has established a structural competitive advantage enabling high growth, customization, margins, and market share. In FY3/27-FY3/29, we expect earnings growth to be driven mainly by heat-dissipation substrates for optical transceivers, as well as xEVs and quartz/SiC products for semiconductor production equipment. We are Buy rated on the stock, as we think earnings growth potential from FY3/27 is not fully factored into the current share price.

Price Target Risks and Methodology - MARUWA

We are Buy rated on MARUWA. Our 12-month target price is ¥89,000 (implies FY27/28E P/E of 29x/23x). Our target price is based on FY28E EBITDA, and we derive the applied multiple of 12.5x from the historical correlation between the EBITDA margin and the

5344.T	12m Price Target: ¥89,000	Price: ¥52,860	Upside: 68.4%
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Buy Market cap: ¥652.2bn / \$4.1bn Enterprise value: ¥567.3bn / \$3.6bn 3m ADTV: ¥12.1bn / \$75.8mn Japan Japan Electronic Components/Semiconductors M&A Rank: 3 Leases incl. in net debt & EV?: Yes	GS Forecast				
		3/26	3/27E	3/28E	3/29E
	Revenue (¥ bn)	74.5	93.3	114.0	132.5
	Op. profit (¥ bn) New	25.0	35.0	52.0	67.0
	Op. profit (¥ bn) Old	25.0	35.0	52.0	67.0
	Op. profit CoE (¥ bn)	27.0	33.7	–	–
	EPS (¥) New	1,471.9	2,041.6	3,074.8	3,921.7
	EPS (¥) Old	1,471.9	2,043.8	3,077.0	3,923.9
	P/E (X)	29.0	25.9	17.2	13.5
	P/B (X)	3.6	3.8	3.2	2.6
CROCI (%)	18.3	23.5	29.9	33.0	
	6/26	9/26E	12/26E	3/27E	
EPS (¥)	361.9	456.6	558.7	629.0	

31 July 2026

Disclosure Appendix

Reg AC

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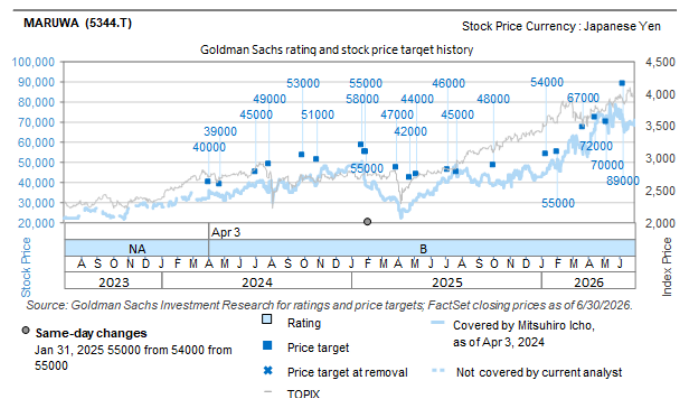
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Target price history table(s)

MARUWA (5344.T)

Date of report Target price (¥) Closing price (¥)

08-Jun-26	89,000	67,750
08-May-26	70,000	68,930
16-Apr-26	72,000	69,200
23-Mar-26	67,000	53,790
03-Feb-26	55,000	51,620
12-Jan-26	54,000	44,550
02-Oct-25	48,000	38,170
24-Jul-25	45,000	46,930
07-Jul-25	46,000	40,020
08-May-25	44,000	32,210
25-Apr-25	42,000	29,375
31-Mar-25	47,000	30,320
01-Feb-25	55,000	38,320
31-Jan-25	54,000	38,320
29-Jan-25	55,000	40,900
22-Jan-25	58,000	50,150
29-Oct-24	51,000	41,650
01-Oct-24	53,000	43,300
29-Jul-24	49,000	40,500
02-Jul-24	45,000	38,300
25-Apr-24	39,000	33,300
03-Apr-24	40,000	32,350

Price targets shown in table(s) are unadjusted for corporate actions.

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